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INDIGNATION

"The reaction of our nation was profound indignation, not relief," said Fidel Castro decades later, recalling his and his comrades' reaction to the Radio Moscow broadcast of Khrushchev's letter to Kennedy. He learned of the letter not from the Soviet ambassador, Aleksandr Alekseev, or from the Radio Moscow broadcast, but from the Associated Press teletype.[1]

It was about noon on October 28 that the editor of a Cuban newspaper called Castro, asking for guidance on how to handle the news. "What news?" asked Castro in surprise. When he realized what was going on, he flew into a rage, smashing the mirror in his home. "Son of a bitch," "bastard," and "asshole" were the expletives he addressed to his alleged savior, Nikita Khrushchev. His reaction was much more emotional than that of John Kennedy on learning twelve days earlier about Khrushchev's missiles in Cuba. "When this news reached us," recalled Castro in the early 1990s, using different vocabulary but still feeling the pain, "we felt that we